Eshet Chayil

אֵשֶׁת חַיִל מִי יִמְצָא, וְרָחֹק מִפְּנִינִים מִכְרָהּ׃

A woman of valor, who can find? And her worth is far beyond pearls.

בָּטַח בָּהּ לֵב בַּעְלָהּ, וְשָׁלָל לֹא יֶחְסָר׃

The heart of her husband trusts in her, and he will lack no gain.

גְּמָלַתְהוּ טוֹב וְלֹא רָע, כֹּל יְמֵי חַיֶּיהָ׃

She renders him good and not evil, all the days of her life.

דָּרְשָׁה צֶמֶר וּפִשְׁתִּים, וַתַּעַשׂ בְּחֵפֶץ כַּפֶּיהָ׃

She seeks out wool and flax, and works willingly [with] her hands.

הָיְתָה כָּאֳנִיּוֹת סוֹחֵר, מִמֶּרְחָק תָּבִיא לַחְמָהּ׃

She is like the merchant ships; from afar she brings her bread.

וַתָּקָם בְּעוֹד לַיְלָה, וַתִּתֵּן טֶרֶף לְבֵיתָהּ וְחֹק לְנַעֲרֹתֶיהָ:

She rises while it is still night, and gives food to her household and a portion to her maidens.

זָמְמָה שָׂדֶה וַתִּקָּחֵהוּ, מִפְּרִי כַפֶּיהָ נָטְעָה כָּרֶם:

She considers a field and acquires it; from the fruit of her hands she plants a vineyard.

חָגְרָה בְעוֹז מָתְנֶיהָ, וַתְּאַמֵּץ זְרוֹעוֹתֶיהָ:

She girds her loins with strength, and strengthens her arms.

אֵשֶׁת חַיִל מִי יִמְצָא, וְרָחֹק מִפְּנִינִים מִכְרָהּ׃

A woman of valor, who can find? And her worth is far beyond pearls.

אֵשֶׁת

a woman of

אֵשֶׁת - woman of *(noun, fem. sg. construct)*

Root **א-נ-ש** - person, mankind

אִשָּׁה - woman

וּמְלַמֵּד לֶאֱנוֹשׁ בִּינָה - and teaches understanding to mankind

אֲנָשִׁים - men

חַיִל

valor

חַיִל - valor *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root ח-י-ל - strength, valor, army

חַיָל - soldier
מֵחַיִל אֶל חָיִל - from strength to strength

מִי

who

מִי - who

יִמְצָא

can find (lit. will find)

יִמְצָא - will find *(Pa'al, future, 3rd masc. sg.)*

Root מ-צ-א - to find

מָצָא - he found
מְצִיאָה - a find, bargain

וְרָחֹק

and far

וְ־ - and

רָחֹק - far *(adjective, masc. sg.)*

Root ר-ח-ק - to be far

רָחוֹק - far

מֶרְחָק - distance

מִפְּנִינִים

beyond pearls

מִ־ - beyond

פְּנִינִים - pearls *(noun, masc. pl.)*

Root פ-נ-ן - pearl

פְּנִינָה - pearl; Peninah

מִכְרָהּ

her worth

מֶכֶר - worth of *(noun, masc. sg. construct)*
ָהּ - her

Root **מ-כ-ר** - to sell

מְכִירָה - sale
מוֹכֵר - seller

בָּטַח בָּהּ לֵב בַּעְלָהּ, וְשָׁלָל לֹא יֶחְסָר׃

The heart of her husband trusts in her, and he will lack no gain.

בָּטַח

trusts (lit. trusted)

בָּטַח - trusted *(Pa'al, past, 3rd masc. sg.)*

Root **ב-ט-ח** - to trust

בִּטָּחוֹן - trust, security
בָּטוּחַ - safe, sure

---

in her בָּהּ

בְּ - in

הָ֫ - her

---

the heart of לֵב

לֵב - heart of *(noun, masc. sg. construct)*

Root ל-ב-ב - heart

לֵב - heart

לִבֵּנוּ - our heart

---

her husband בַּעְלָהּ

בַּעַל - husband of *(noun, masc. sg. construct)*

הָ֫ - her

Root ב-ע-ל - to own, master; husband

בַּעַל - husband, owner

בַּעַל תְּשׁוּבָה - one who has returned to Judaism

וְשָׁלָל

and gain

וְ - and

שָׁלָל - gain, spoil *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root ש-ל-ל - to plunder

אֶחַלֵּק שָׁלָל - I will divide the spoil

לֹא

not

לֹא - not

יֶחְסָר

he will lack

יֶחְסָר - he will lack *(Pa'al, future, 3rd masc. sg.)*

Root ח-ס-ר - to lack

יְיָ רֹעִי לֹא אֶחְסָר - the LORD is my shepherd, I shall not lack

חָסֵר - lacking

גְּמָלַתְהוּ טוֹב וְלֹא רָע, כֹּל יְמֵי חַיֶּיהָ׃

She renders him good and not evil, all the days of her life.

גְּמָלַתְהוּ

she renders him (lit. she rendered him)

גָּמְלָה - she rendered *(Pa'al, past, 3rd fem. sg.)*

־הוּ - him

Root ג-מ-ל - to render, deal out; to wean

גּוֹמֵל חֲסָדִים טוֹבִים - Who bestows good kindnesses

גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים - acts of kindness

בִּרְכַּת הַגּוֹמֵל - the blessing of thanksgiving

טוֹב

good

טוֹב - good *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root ט-ו-ב - good

הַטּוֹב - the Good One

הַמֵּטִיב - Who does good

וְלֹא

and not

וְ - and
לֹא - not

רָע

evil

רָע - evil *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root **ר-ע-ע** - bad, evil

רָעָה - evil, harm
יֵצֶר הָרָע - the evil inclination
לֹא אִירָא רָע - I will fear no evil

כֹּל

all of

כֹּל - all of *(noun, masc. sg. construct)*

Root **כ-ל-ל** - whole, all, to include

הַכֹּל - everything
כָּלִיל - complete

---

the days of יְמֵי

יְמֵי - days of *(noun, masc. pl. construct)*

Root י-ו-ם - day

הַיּוֹם - today
יוֹמָם - by day

---

her life חַיֶּיהָ

חַיֵּי - life of *(noun, masc. pl. construct)*
ֶּיהָ - her

Root ח-י-ה - to live

חַיִּים - life
מְחַיֶּה - revives

דָּרְשָׁה צֶמֶר וּפִשְׁתִּים, וַתַּעַשׂ בְּחֵפֶץ כַּפֶּיהָ׃

She seeks out wool and flax, and works willingly [with] her hands.

דָּרְשָׁה **she seeks out (lit. she sought out)**

דָּרְשָׁה - she sought out *(Pa'al, past, 3rd fem. sg.)*

Root **ד-ר-ש** - to seek, inquire, expound

מִדְרָשׁ - midrash

דְּרָשָׁה - sermon

בֵּית מִדְרָשׁ - house of study

צֶמֶר

wool

צֶמֶר - wool *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root צ-מ-ר - wool

צֶמֶר גֶּפֶן - cotton wool
צַמֶּרֶת - treetop, top echelon

וּפִשְׁתִּים

and flax

וּ־ - and
פִּשְׁתִּים - flax *(noun, masc. pl.)*

Root פ-ש-ת - flax

פִּשְׁתָּן - flax, linen

וַתַּעַשׂ

and she works (lit. and she worked)

וַ־ - and *(vav consecutive)*

תַּעֲשֶׂה - she will work *(Pa'al, future, 3rd fem. sg.)*

Root **ע-ש-ה** - to do, make

עֹשֶׂה שָׁלוֹם - Who makes peace

מַעֲשֶׂה - deed

מַעֲשֵׂה בְרֵאשִׁית - the work of creation

בְּחֵפֶץ

willingly (lit. with desire)

בְּ־ - with

חֵפֶץ - desire *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root **ח-פ-ץ** - to desire, delight in

מֶלֶךְ חָפֵץ בַּחַיִּים - King Who desires life

חֵפֶץ - desire; object

---

her hands כַּפֶּיהָ

כַּפֵּי - hands of *(noun, fem. dual construct)*

ֶיהָ - her

Root כ-פ-ף - palm, to bend

כַּף - palm, spoon

נְשִׂיאַת כַּפַּיִם - raising of the hands (the Priestly Blessing)

הָיְתָה כָּאֳנִיּוֹת סוֹחֵר, מִמֶּרְחָק תָּבִיא לַחְמָהּ׃

She is like the merchant ships; from afar she brings her bread.

הָיְתָה

she is (lit. she was)

הָיְתָה - she was *(Pa'al, past, 3rd fem. sg.)*

Root ה-י-ה - to be

הָיָה - was
יִהְיֶה - will be

כָּאֳנִיּוֹת

like the ships of

כְּ- - like
אֳנִיּוֹת - ships of *(noun, fem. pl. construct)*

Root א-נ-י - ship

אֳנִיָּה - ship
אֳנִי - fleet

סוֹחֵר

a merchant

סוֹחֵר - merchant *(Pa'al, participle, masc. sg.)*

Root ס-ח-ר - to trade, go around

סְחוֹרָה - merchandise
מִסְחָר - commerce

מִמֶּרְחָק

from afar

מִ־ - from
מֶרְחָק - distance *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root ר-ח-ק - to be far

רָחוֹק - far
מֶרְחָק - distance

---

she brings (lit. she will bring) תָּבִיא

תָּבִיא - she will bring *(Hif'il, future, 3rd fem. sg.)*

Root ב-ו-א - to come

בּוֹאִי - come

וּבָא - and will come

---

her bread לַחְמָהּ

לֶחֶם - bread of *(noun, masc. sg. construct)*

ָהּ - her

Root ל-ח-ם - bread; to fight

מִלְחָמָה - war

וַתָּקָם בְּעוֹד לַיְלָה, וַתִּתֵּן טֶרֶף לְבֵיתָהּ
וְחֹק לְנַעֲרֹתֶיהָ:

She rises while it is still night, and gives food to her household and a portion to her maidens.

וַתָּקָם **and she rises (lit. and she rose)**

וַ־ - and *(vav consecutive)*

תָּקוּם - she will rise *(Pa'al, future, 3rd fem. sg.)*

Root **ק-ו-ם** - to rise, to stand up

קוּמִי - arise

מָקוֹם - place

בְּעוֹד

while still

בְּ־ - while
עוֹד - still

Root ע-ו-ד - to testify; still, again; until, ever

עֵדֹתֶיךָ - Your testimonies
עֵד - witness
עוֹד - still, again, more

לַיְלָה

night

לַיְלָה - night *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root ל-י-ל - night

לֵיל שַׁבָּת - Friday night
מַה נִּשְׁתַּנָּה הַלַּיְלָה הַזֶּה - why is this night different

---

and she gives (lit. and she gave) **וַתִּתֵּן**

וַ - and *(vav consecutive)*

תִּתֵּן - she will give *(Pa'al, future, 3rd fem. sg.)*

Root נ-ת-ן - to give

נוֹתֵן הַתּוֹרָה - Giver of the Torah

מַתָּנָה - gift

מַתַּן תּוֹרָה - the giving of the Torah

---

food **טֶרֶף**

טֶרֶף - food, prey *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root ט-ר-ף - to tear; prey

טְרֵפָה - non-kosher (torn) meat

טֶרֶף - prey

---

to her household לְבֵיתָהּ

לְ- - to

בֵּית - household of *(noun, masc. sg. construct)*

ָהּ - her

Root ב-י-ת - house

בַּיִת - house

בֵּית כְּנֶסֶת - synagogue

בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ - the Temple

---

and a portion וְחֹק

וְ- - and

חֹק - portion *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root ח-ק-ק - to engrave, decree

חֻקֵּי רְצוֹנֶךָ - the statutes of Your will

חֻקָּה - statute

---

to her maidens לְנַעֲרֹתֶיהָ

לְ- - to

נַעֲרֹת - maidens of *(noun, fem. pl. construct)*

ֶיהָ - her

Root נ-ע-ר - youth

נַעַר הָיִיתִי גַּם זָקַנְתִּי - I was young and have also grown old

נַעַר - boy, youth

נְעוּרִים - youth

זָמְמָה שָׂדֶה וַתִּקָּחֵהוּ, מִפְּרִי כַפֶּיהָ נָטְעָה כָּרֶם:

She considers a field and acquires it; from the fruit of her hands she plants a vineyard.

זָמְמָה

she considers (lit. she considered)

זָמְמָה - she considered *(Pa'al, past, 3rd fem. sg.)*

Root ז-מ-ם - to plan, scheme

מְזִמָּה - scheme, plot

כַּאֲשֶׁר זָמַם - as he schemed

שָׂדֶה

a field

שָׂדֶה - field *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root ש-ד-ה - field

וְנָתַתִּי עֵשֶׂב בְּשָׂדְךָ - and I will give grass in your field

שָׂדוֹת - fields

---

and she acquires it (lit. and she acquired it) וַתִּקָּחֵהוּ

וַ־ - and *(vav consecutive)*

תִּקַּח - she will acquire *(Pa'al, future, 3rd fem. sg.)*

ֵהוּ - it *(masc. sg.)*

Root ל-ק-ח - to take

כִּי לֶקַח טוֹב נָתַתִּי לָכֶם - for I have given you good teaching

לָקַח - he took

---

from the fruit of מִפְּרִי

מִ־ - from

פְּרִי - fruit of *(noun, masc. sg. construct)*

Root פ-ר-ה - to bear fruit

בּוֹרֵא פְּרִי הַגָּפֶן - Who creates the fruit of the vine

פְּרוּ וּרְבוּ - be fruitful and multiply

---

her hands כַּפֶּיהָ

כַּפֵּי - hands of *(noun, fem. dual construct)*

ֶיהָ - her

Root כ-פ-ף - palm, to bend

כַּף - palm, spoon

נְשִׂיאַת כַּפַּיִם - raising of the hands (the Priestly Blessing)

---

she plants (lit. she planted) נָטְעָה

נָטְעָה - she planted *(Pa'al, past, 3rd fem. sg.)*

Root נ-ט-ע - to plant

וְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם נָטַע בְּתוֹכֵנוּ - and planted eternal life within us

נְטִיעָה - planting

---

a vineyard כֶּרֶם

כֶּרֶם - vineyard *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root כ-ר-ם - vineyard

כּוֹרֵם - vintner

כַּרְמִי - Carmi

חָגְרָה בְעוֹז מָתְנֶיהָ, וַתְּאַמֵּץ זְרוֹעוֹתֶיהָ׃

She girds her loins with strength, and strengthens her arms.

---

she girds (lit. she girded) חָגְרָה

חָגְרָה - she girded *(Pa'al, past, 3rd fem. sg.)*

Root ח-ג-ר - to gird

חֲגוֹרָה - belt

מָתְנֵיכֶם חֲגֻרִים - your loins girded

בְּעוֹז

with strength

בְּ־ - with

עוֹז - strength *(noun, masc. sg.)*

Root ע-ז-ז - to be strong

עֹז - strength

יְיָ עֹז לְעַמּוֹ יִתֵּן - the LORD will give strength to His people

עַז - strong, fierce

מָתְנֶיהָ

her loins

מָתְנֵי - loins of *(noun, masc. dual construct)*

ֶיהָ - her

Root מ-ת-ן - loins; to wait

מֹתֶן - waist, hip

הַמְתָּנָה - waiting

וַתְּאַמֵּץ

and she strengthens (lit. and she strengthened)

וַ־ - and *(vav consecutive)*

תְּאַמֵּץ - she will strengthen *(Pi'el, future, 3rd fem. sg.)*

Root **א-מ-ץ** - to be strong, brave

חֲזַק וֶאֱמָץ - be strong and courageous

אֹמֶץ - courage

זְרֹעוֹתֶיהָ

her arms

זְרֹעוֹת - arms of *(noun, fem. pl. construct)*

ֶיהָ - her

Root **ז-ר-ע** - to sow, seed; arm

זוֹרֵעַ צְדָקוֹת - Who sows righteousness

בִּזְרֹעַ נְטוּיָה - with an outstretched arm

זֶרַע - seed, offspring
